

WhatsApp free on iOS

WhatsApp will be free to download on iOS and free to use for the first year after which users will have to pay an annual subscription fee

BlackBerry Q5 makes it to India

BlackBerry has announced the upcoming availability of its first mid-range BB10 device in India, the BlackBerry Q5, at a price of ₹24,990

Intel diligence

Narendra Bhandari, Director of Software Group and Developer Relations at Intel, shares insight on mobile devices, open source, Tizen and all you wanted to know about Intel's plans for the future...

Nash David

nashb.david@thinkdigit.com

1 The recent years have witnessed tremendous activity in the area of application development. We've also seen platforms emerge and disappear by the passing day. What in your opinion would it take for a platform to grow through the ranks?

Application development and platforms for development is an evolving process. The developer has to make a choice on quite a few new variables than the development platform alone. E.g. In recent years cross platform applicability code, importance of User Experience, Security and manageability of code, application monetization methods and access to a large third party API base have evolved. This has made the developer choice a difficult one on which areas to focus on. That's why it may appear that the platforms have a shorter life. The developers are exploring, experimenting with these new Developer dimensions and looking at how these new tools help them to shorten the life cycle of the project or an app.

If these new variables are able to sustain the developer interest and provide them the right mix of agility, performance and applicability for creating new usages, the "lego" model of app development will be here to stay for a long time and we see the app development platform as a collection of many components than a monolithic stack.

A successful platform either has to provide these critical stack components or has to be open to accept the third party APIs and allow the developer to mash up together.

2 With the heavy focus on Android, has Intel settled with Android for mobile devices as its preferred platform?

Intel has always believed in port of choice for app developers, Intel on its platforms



Narendra Bhandari, Intel

has supported a wide range of Operating systems. On the Mobile devices platform, Intel has started with Meego, now part of Tizen and Android as a port of Choice. With increased number of developers adopting Android WW, it will benefit developers to also explore Intel architecture to develop applications.

3 What is the approach towards Tizen going to look like in the near horizon?

Intel participates in the fully open software platform, Tizen™, an evolution of the MeeGo project. Tizen is an open source project led by the LiMo Foundation and the Linux Foundation. It is a Linux-based operating system platform based on emerging standards including an application programming interface based on HTML5 and other web standards. Tizen is backed by many major Linux proponents and will be supported and promoted as a viable open source alternative with a transparent governance structure that spans across multiple device segments including netbooks, tablets, connected TVs, smartphones andIVI systems.

Last Spring, the Tizen project reached a major milestone by providing the open source developer community with a Tizen 1.0 ("Larkspur") SDK and source code for smartphone devices. The Tizen 2.0 source code and SDK (called Magnolia) were released in February 2013. The release allows OEMs to consider Tizen 2.0 for their commercial devices, and open source developers to look into Tizen to find what they can improve and contribute. It also allows developers to begin to develop and port apps to the Tizen platform.

Intel is very committed to the development of Tizen. We see a unique role for Tizen in the industry to create and to grow a new, open and flexible, mobile operating system that allows developers to write once/run on many devices. Tizen has received broad industry support through the Tizen Association and has achieved major milestones this year including establishing the storefront, releasing the Tizen 2.1 source code, the Tizen IVI 2.0 and the Tizen 2.2 Beta SDK that was just released recently.

On 9th July, The Tizen org has announced an application challenge which offers prizes of @ 4 Million USD. This challenge will help to expedite the applications availability in Tizen store across 9 different categories. Details available at <https://developer.tizen.org/contests/tizen-app-challenge>

4 What are points a developer must consider before adapting a platform of choice?

The developer used to think about a certain dimensions for a software development project. Functionality of the code, IDE or dev environment used and performance for a workload used to be the key points any developer used to be focused on. Today the developer dimensions are evolved to add more vectors which include Cross Platform development needs, User Experience, App monetiza-